2008 Toyota Camry Hybrid

$7,900 · 140,000 miles · Dealer · Lancaster, CA

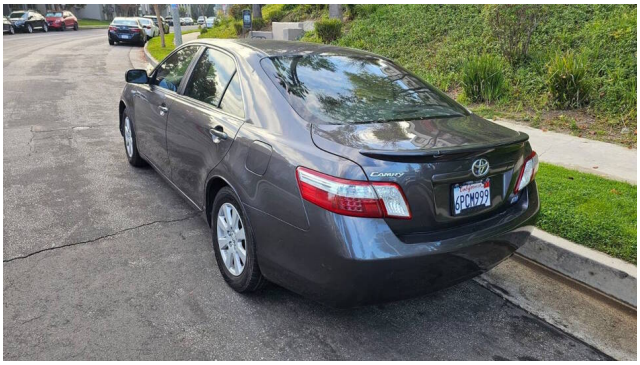
Seller: Atlantic Auto Sales And Finance (dealer), Lancaster

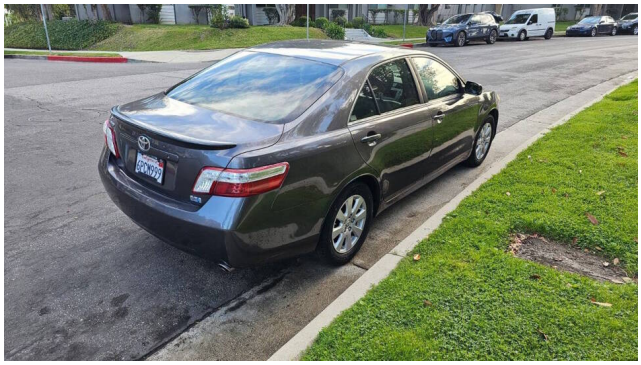
Source: AutosToday

Listing: https://www.autostoday.com/cars-for-sale/used-cars/listing/JTNBB46K383048472/2008-toyota-camry-2-4-auto-hybrid-lancaster-ca

Report generated October 27, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









+ 1 more photos in the app.

Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$8,995	**$502**	**Average**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	3/5 · 8 recalls · 1,178 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$7,900.00
Sales tax (9.25%)	$730.75
Dealer doc + filing fees	$125.00
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$51.35
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$65.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$8,995.10
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$5,000.00
Amount financed	$3,995.10
Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR)	$80.05
Total interest over the loan	$808.12
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$5,150.00

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$80.05
Insurance (estimate, full)	$135.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 34 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$139.71
Maintenance & repair reserve	$130.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$16.78
Total per month	$501.54

Running costs without the loan: **$421/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$14,479** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Average (3/5)

Average given its age: the Camry Hybrid's drivetrain is durable, but at 18 years the hybrid battery is the big risk (refurbished pack roughly $1,500-3,000), and the 2007-2009 Camrys share the sticky-dashboard problem.

NHTSA data for this model year: 8 recalls · 1,178 owner complaints (109 involving a crash). Most complaints: Visibility (210), Structure (186), Vehicle Speed Control (169), Service Brakes (149), Engine (144), Unknown Or Other (129).

Known issues for this model

• Hybrid battery capacity loss with age

• Inverter coolant pump failure (hybrid system warning)

• Sticky/melting dashboard in heat

• Brake actuator wear

Check on this car before buying

• Hybrid battery health test at an independent hybrid shop

• No hybrid-system, check-engine or ABS warnings

• A/C cold (electric compressor)

• Run VIN for recalls (floor mat/accelerator, window switch)

Notes

$7,900, 140k mi. AutoCheck via AutosToday: clean title, ACCIDENT FREE, multiple owners, personal use. Listed 184 days -> negotiate.

Midsize comfort with ~33 city MPG (vs ~21 for a regular Camry). Dealer offers in-house financing - not needed if Dad pays cash.

~1.5 hr drive from Ridgecrest (CA-14). Call/text first to confirm availability and get the out-the-door price.

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.